

Structural Systems

Texas Real Estate Commission Standards of Practice · **22 TAC 535.228** · For the TREC state exam (25 questions, pass at 75%)

The largest technical section, running (a) to (j). Note the pattern that repeats throughout: each subsection tells you what to **report**, what to **report as Deficient**, and what you are **not required** to do.

The ten subsections, in order

- (a) Foundations
- (b) Grading and Drainage
- (c) Roof Covering Materials
- (d) Roof Structures and Attics
- (e) Interior Walls, Ceilings, Floors and Doors
- (f) Exterior Walls, Doors and Windows
- (g) Exterior and Interior Glazing
- (h) Interior and Exterior Stairways
- (i) Fireplaces and Chimneys
- (j) Porches, Balconies, Decks and Carports

(a) Foundations — the most Texas-specific duty in the SOP

The inspector shall:

- **Render a written opinion as to the performance of the foundation;** and
- Report the **type of foundation** and the **vantage point** from which the crawl space was inspected.

This is the single most distinctive rule in the Texas SOP. Nowhere else are you required to give a written *opinion on performance* — the national standard has you describe and report, not opine. Texas expects a judgement: is the foundation performing, or not.

The distinction to hold: an opinion on *performance* is not an engineering analysis and not a warranty. You are saying how it appears to be performing on the day, from what you could see.

(b) Grading and Drainage

Surface drainage away from the structure, standing water, and the condition of grading around the foundation. Remember the general limitation: **sub-surface drainage systems are excluded**, and so is **concrete flatwork** such as driveways and walkways.

(c) and (d) Roof Covering, Structures and Attics

The covering subsection deals with the material, its condition and its penetrations. The structures and attics subsection deals with framing, decking, ventilation and insulation, and it requires you to report the **vantage point** from which the attic was inspected — the same idea as the crawl space.

The vantage point rule appears twice — crawl space in (a), attic in (d). Texas wants the report to say where you looked from, because that defines what you could actually see.

(e) to (h) Walls, Doors, Windows, Glazing and Stairways

Interior and exterior surfaces, door and window operation, and **glazing** — which is where safety glass questions live. Stairways cover treads, risers, handrails and guards.

(i) Fireplaces and Chimneys

Fireboxes, dampers, hearth extensions, and chimney condition and termination.

(j) Porches, Balconies, Decks and Carports

The trap that catches people. The general limitations say you need not inspect *detached* decks. But (j) requires you to inspect porches, balconies, decks and carports that are **attached** to the dwelling. Attached is in; detached is out.

Check Yourself

1. What must a Texas inspector do about a foundation that no national standard requires?

Render a written opinion as to its performance.

2. Which two subsections require reporting a vantage point?

Foundations (crawl space) and Roof Structures and Attics.

3. A deck is attached to the house. In or out of scope?

In, under 535.228(j). Only detached decks are excluded.

Content follows the official TREC Standards of Practice, 22 TAC 535.227-535.233. Rules are amended periodically — verify against the current version on trec.texas.gov before the exam.